



Runs entirely on your Windows computer

Tender Monitor

User Handbook & Installation Guide

for first-time users

Version 1.0 · Windows 10 / 11

A step-by-step guide to install and use Tender Monitor to track government e-procurement tenders automatically.

Made by Ganguly B (Shavarna)

enlaceet@gmail.com · WhatsApp +91-9073288770

Free & open source (MIT License)

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1. What is Tender Monitor?

Tender Monitor is a small application that runs on your own Windows computer and watches government **e-procurement / tender websites** for you. You tell it which websites to watch and what words you care about (for example *water, pipeline, WTP, STP*); it visits those sites on a schedule, finds the tenders, and tells you which ones are **new** or **changed** since last time.

It can:

- Monitor any number of public tender portals (NIC eProcurement portals like wb.tenders.gov.in are supported automatically).
- Detect **NEW** and **UPDATED** tenders (e.g. a closing date extended).
- Download publicly available tender documents (NIT, BOQ, corrigendum, etc.).
- Score tenders by relevance to your keywords (HIGH / MEDIUM / LOW).
- Produce a professional Excel report and keep a full local history.
- Run automatically every day, even when the window is closed.

Everything stays on your computer. There is no website to sign up for and no cloud account. The app opens in your normal web browser at `http://127.0.0.1:8000`, which is just your own machine.

2. Before you begin (what you need)

- A computer with **Windows 10 or 11**.
- **Python 3.12 or newer** (a free program the app is built on).
- About **300 MB** of free disk space.
- An internet connection (to reach the tender websites you monitor).

Check if you already have Python

Open the Start menu, type `cmd`, open **Command Prompt**, type this and press Enter:

```
python --version
```

If it shows `Python 3.12` (or higher), you are ready. If it says Python is not found, install it first:

1. Go to <https://www.python.org/downloads/> and download the latest Windows installer.
2. Run the installer and - very important - tick **"Add Python to PATH"** at the bottom of the first screen.
3. Click **Install Now** and wait for it to finish.

Don't skip "Add Python to PATH". If you forget it, the install step below will not be able to find Python. You can re-run the Python installer and tick it if needed.

3. Step 1 - Install the application

You should have a folder for the app, for example `D:\Tender Hunt` , containing files such as `install.bat` and `start.bat` .

1. Open that folder in File Explorer.
2. Double-click **install.bat**.
3. A black window opens and sets everything up automatically. It will: create a private workspace, download the parts it needs, install a built-in browser it uses to read websites, and prepare the database.
4. This takes a few minutes the first time. When you see "*Installation complete*", press a key to close the window.

You only ever run **install.bat** **once**. After that you start the app with **start.bat**.

4. Step 2 - Start the application

1. Double-click **start.bat** in the same folder.
2. A black window opens (leave it open - that is the app running) and your web browser opens automatically at **http://127.0.0.1:8000**.
3. You should see the **Dashboard** shown below.

Tender Monitor v1.0.0 Dashboard Portals Tenders Archive Scan History Settings Idle

Dashboard [Add Portal](#) [Run All Now](#) [View New Tenders](#) [View Updated Tenders](#) [Download Excel](#) [View Scan History](#) [Settings](#)

2
Configured Portals

2
Scanned OK

0
Need Attention

4
Total Tenders

3
New (latest)

1
Updated (latest)

0
Documents

2026-09-14T13:55:19+00:00
Last Successful Scan

2026-09-15T08:00:00+05:30
Next Scheduled Scan

Recent Scans

PORTAL	STARTED	FOUND	NEW	UPD	DOCS	STATUS
Goa eProcurement	2026-09-14T13:55:19+00:00	60	1	0	1	baseline
West Bengal eProcurement	2026-09-14T13:55:19+00:00	124	3	1	6	success

Recent Errors

No recent errors.

Notifications

info Scan complete: West Bengal eProcurement
3 new, 1 updated, 6 documents downloaded.

Tender Monitor runs entirely on your computer. Next scheduled scan: 2026-09-15T08:00:00+05:30

The Dashboard - your home screen. This is what opens when you start the app.

To stop the app later: close the black window, or double-click **stop.bat**. To use the app again another day, just double-click **start.bat**.

5. Step 3 - Understand the Dashboard

The Dashboard gives you the big picture at a glance:

- **Configured Portals / Scanned OK / Need Attention** - how many websites you watch and their health.
- **Total Tenders, New (latest), Updated (latest), Documents** - what the app has found.
- **Last Successful Scan** and **Next Scheduled Scan**.
- **Recent Scans, Recent Errors** and **Notifications** panels.

The buttons at the top - **Add Portal, Run All Now, View New Tenders, Download Excel, View Scan History, Settings** - are shortcuts to everything you need. The blue bar at the very top (Dashboard, Portals, Tenders, Archive, Scan History, Settings) is the main menu, always available.

6. Step 4 - Add your first tender portal

Click **Add Portal** (top of the Dashboard). Fill in the form and click **Save Portal**. Below is an example set up to watch water-sector tenders.

Tender Monitor v1.0.0DashboardPortalsTendersArchiveScan HistorySettingsIdle

Edit PortalBack to Portals

Portal Name

West Bengal eProcurement

Monitoring

☒ Enabled

Run Time (HH:MM)

08 : 00

Negative Keywords (comma-separated)

vehicle, canteen

Location Filter (optional)

West Bengal

Maximum Tender Value (optional)

Maximum Pages

5

Browser Mode

Headless

Follow Detail Pages

☐ Enrich from tender detail pages

Store only matching tenders

☐ Keep only tenders that match your keywords

Test Portal

Save Portal

Website URL

https://wbttenders.gov.in/nicgep/app

Schedule

Daily

Keywords (comma-separated)

water, pipeline, WTP, STP, JJM

Keyword Mode

Match ANY keyword

Minimum Tender Value (optional)

Download Documents

☒ Yes

Delay Between Requests (seconds)

1.0

First Scan Handling

☐ Treat first scan as NEW (default: baseline only)

Organisations to scan (NIC portals only)

60

Tender Monitor runs entirely on your computer. Next scheduled scan: 2026-09-15T08:00:00+05:30

The Add Portal form, filled in with an example.

Field	What to put
Portal Name	Any label, e.g. <i>West Bengal eProcurement</i>
Website URL	The site address, e.g. <code>https://wbtenders.gov.in/nicgep/app</code>
Monitoring	Tick Enabled
Schedule	<i>Daily</i> (recommended) or <i>Manual</i>
Run Time	When the daily scan runs, e.g. <code>08:00</code>
Keywords	Words you care about, e.g. <code>water, pipeline, WTP, STP, JJM</code>
Negative Keywords	Words to exclude, e.g. <code>vehicle, canteen</code>
Keyword Mode	<i>Match ANY keyword</i> (broad) or <i>ALL</i> (strict)
Location / Min / Max Value	Optional filters
Download Documents	Yes to save PDFs/BOQ for matching tenders
Organisations to scan	For NIC portals: how many departments to cover (default 60)
Store only matching tenders	Tick to keep only tenders that match your keywords
Browser Mode	Leave as <i>Headless</i>

Good news for Indian government portals: most state tender sites (West Bengal, Goa, Odisha, and others ending in `/nicgep/app`) are recognised **automatically**. Just paste the site's main address - the app knows how to read their "Tenders by Organisation" pages.

7. Step 5 - Test the portal

Before saving, click **Test Portal**. The app opens the website with its built-in browser and checks whether it can read tenders from it. After a few seconds you get a result like this:

Tender Monitor v1.0.0DashboardPortalsTendersArchiveScan HistorySettingsIdle

Add PortalBack to Portals

Portal Name

Website URL

Monitoring

Schedule

Run Time (HH:MM)

Keywords (comma-separated)

Negative Keywords (comma-separated)

Keyword Mode

Location Filter (optional)

Minimum Tender Value (optional)

Maximum Tender Value (optional)

Download Documents

Maximum Pages

Delay Between Requests (seconds)

Browser Mode

First Scan Handling

Follow Detail Pages

Organisations to scan (NIC portals only)

Store only matching tenders

Test Portal

Save Portal

Portal Test Result

Automation Readiness: **SUPPORTED (NIC eProcurement)**

CHECK	RESULT	DETAIL
Website reachable	PASS	HTTP 200
HTTPS	PASS	https://wbttenders.gov.in/nicgep/app
NIC eProcurement portal	DETECTED	Scans via Tenders by Organisation (no CAPTCHA)
Tender listing (organisation page)	PASS	28 tender(s) sampled
Tender ID	PASS	
Published date	PASS	
Closing date	PASS	
Organisation	PASS	
Document links	PASS	

Tender Monitor runs entirely on your computer. Next scheduled scan: 2026-09-15T08:00:00+05:30

A successful Test Portal result for a NIC eProcurement site.

Look at **Automation Readiness** at the top:

Result	Meaning
SUPPORTED / GOOD	The app can read this site. Save and scan it.
SUPPORTED (NIC eProcurement)	Recognised government portal - it will scan via "Tenders by Organisation".
PARTIALLY SUPPORTED	Some fields may be missing, but it will still work.
CAPTCHA / LOGIN REQUIRED	The site is protected; the app will not (and should not) bypass it.
SITE UNAVAILABLE / BLOCKED	The site could not be reached right now - try again later.

For NIC portals the individual date/ID rows are read from the real "Tenders by Organisation" pages during the test, so you will see **Published date**, **Closing date** and **Organisation** marked PASS. Then click **Save Portal**.

8. Step 6 - Run your first scan

You can scan any time - you do not have to wait for the schedule.

- From the **Dashboard**, click **Run All Now** to scan every enabled portal, or
- Go to **Portals** and click **Scan** next to one portal.

A NIC portal walks through each government department, so the first scan can take a few minutes. Watch progress on the **Scan History** page.

Tender Monitor v1.0.0 Dashboard Portals Tenders Archive Scan History Settings											
Scan History											Idle
Run All Now											
#	PORTAL	STARTED	FINISHED	DUR(S)	PAGES	FOUND	NEW	UPD	DOCS	ERR	STATUS
2	Goa eProcurement	2026-09-14T13:34:52+00:00	2026-09-14T13:34:52+00:00	22.7	36	60	1	0	1	0	baseline
1	West Bengal eProcurement	2026-09-14T13:34:52+00:00	2026-09-14T13:34:52+00:00	48.2	60	124	3	1	6	0	success

Tender Monitor runs entirely on your computer. Next scheduled scan: 2026-09-15T08:00:00+05:30

Scan History - every scan with how many tenders were found, new, updated and downloaded.

The very first scan of a portal is a "baseline". It records everything that is already there but does not flag it all as NEW (that would be thousands of old tenders). From the **second** scan onward, only genuinely new or changed tenders are flagged NEW / UPDATED.

Tidy tip: right after your first baseline scan, use **Archive reviewed** (see Step 9) to clear the old pile so that, going forward, your Tenders list only fills with genuinely new tenders.

9. Step 7 - View and filter tenders

Click **Tenders** in the top menu. This shows the tenders the app has found, with their Published and Closing dates, value, a **relevance** badge and a status (new / updated / existing).

Tender Monitor v1.0.0DashboardPortalsTendersArchiveScan HistorySettingsIdle

Tenders (5)

New todayPublished todayDownload ExcelArchive reviewedArchive allView Archive

All portals

Keyword

Tender ID

Organisation

Location

Any status

Any relevance

Min value

Max value

Published fromdd-mm-yyyyto dd-mm-yyyyFilterReset

PORTAL	TENDER	ORGANISATION	PUBLISHED	CLOSING	VALUE	RELEVANCE	STATUS	
West Bengal eProcurement	Providing water supply pipeline under Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) 2026_PHED_1038149_1 NIEt-26/AD/26-27/01	PHED SOUTH 24 PARGANAS ALIPORE DIVISION	2026-09-14	2026-09-29	Rs. 1.5 Crore	HIGH 92	new	Archive
West Bengal eProcurement	Construction of Water Treatment Plant (WTP) at Baruipur 2026_PHED_1038150_2 NIEt-26/AD/26-27/02	PHED SOUTH 24 PARGANAS ALIPORE DIVISION	2026-09-14	2026-10-05	Rs. 8 Lakh	HIGH 85	new	Archive
West Bengal eProcurement	Sewerage (STP) network rehabilitation work 2026_PHED_1038151_3 NIEt-26/AD/26-27/03	Municipal Corporation Kolkata	2026-09-13	2026-09-27	Rs. 45 Lakh	MEDIUM 55	updated	Archive
Goa eProcurement	Replacement of 400mm CI water conveying main 2026_DDW_31843_1 PWD/DIV/13/2026	DEPARTMENT OF DRINKING WATER CIRCLE - I	2026-09-14	2026-09-28	Rs. 22 Lakh	HIGH 78	new	Archive
Goa eProcurement	Road resurfacing near Panaji constituency 2026_PWD_31853_1 PWD/DIVISION XVI/TS/13	PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT DIVISION XVI	2026-09-13	2026-09-24	Rs. 12 Lakh	MEDIUM 40	existing	Archive

Tender Monitor runs entirely on your computer. Next scheduled scan: 2026-09-15T08:00:00+05:30

The Tenders page. Use the filters and the quick-view buttons at the top.

The two most useful buttons, at the top:

- **New today** - tenders the app first saw today. This is the fastest way to see "what came in since yesterday".
- **Published today** - tenders whose official published date is today.

You can also filter by portal, keyword, organisation, location, status, **relevance** and a **Published date range**. To focus on the best matches, set **Relevance = HIGH**.

Tender Monitorv1.0.0DashboardPortalsTendersArchiveScan HistorySettingsIdle

Tenders (3)

New todayPublished todayDownload ExcelArchive reviewedArchive allView Archive

All portalsKeywordTender IDOrganisationLocationnew

Any relevanceMin valueMax valuePublished fromdd-mm-yyyyto dd-mm-yyyyFilterReset

PORTAL	TENDER	ORGANISATION	PUBLISHED	CLOSING	VALUE	RELEVANCE	STATUS
West Bengal eProcurement	Providing water supply pipeline under Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) 2026_PHED_1038149_1 NIeT-26/AD/26-27/01	PHED SOUTH 24 PARGANAS ALIPORE DIVISION	2026-09-14	2026-09-29	Rs. 1.5 Crore	HIGH 92	new Archive
West Bengal eProcurement	Construction of Water Treatment Plant (WTP) at Baruipur 2026_PHED_1038150_2 NIeT-26/AD/26-27/02	PHED SOUTH 24 PARGANAS ALIPORE DIVISION	2026-09-14	2026-10-05	Rs. 8 Lakh	HIGH 85	new Archive
Goa eProcurement	Replacement of 400mm CI water conveying main 2026_DDW_31843_1 PWD/DIV/13/2026	DEPARTMENT OF DRINKING WATER CIRCLE - I	2026-09-14	2026-09-28	Rs. 22 Lakh	HIGH 78	new Archive

Tender Monitor runs entirely on your computer. Next scheduled scan: 2026-09-15T08:00:00+05:30

Filtering to only NEW tenders - your daily short-list.

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10. Step 8 - Open a tender's details

Click any tender's title to see everything about it: full metadata, the source link, downloaded **documents**, and its **change history** (for example "CLOSING DATE EXTENDED" with the old and new dates).

Tender Monitor v1.0.0DashboardPortalsTendersArchiveScan HistorySettingsIdle

Providing water supply pipeline under Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM)

newHIGH 92Back

Details

Portal	West Bengal eProcurement
Tender ID	2026_PHED_1038149_1
Reference	NleT-26/AD/26-27/01
Organisation	PHED SOUTH 24 PARGANAS ALIPORE DIVISION
Department	
Category	
Location	West Bengal
Published	2026-09-14
Submission Start	
Closing	2026-09-29
Opening	2026-09-29
Estimated Value	Rs. 1.5 Crore
EMD	Rs. 30,000
Tender Fee	Rs. 500
Work Period	
Eligibility	
Source	
Detail Page	https://wbtenders.gov.in/nicgep/app
First Seen	2026-09-14T13:34:52+00:00
Last Seen	2026-09-14T13:34:52+00:00

Documents (0)

No documents recorded.

Change History (0)

WHEN	FIELD	CHANGE	OLD	NEW
No changes recorded yet.				

Tender Monitor runs entirely on your computer. Next scheduled scan: 2026-09-15T08:00:00+05:30

A tender's detail page, including documents and change history.

11. Step 9 - Keep the list tidy with Archive

Over time the Tenders list grows. To keep it focused on what is current, move old or already-reviewed tenders to the **Archive** (nothing is deleted - archived tenders are just hidden from the main list and can be restored any time).

On the **Tenders** page, three buttons help:

Button	What it does
Archive reviewed	Archives all <i>unchanged</i> tenders, keeps NEW and UPDATED. Best for daily clean-up.
Archive all	Moves everything in the active list to the Archive (a full clear).
Archive (per row)	Archive one tender using the small button on its row.

Open the **Archive** page from the top menu to search old tenders and **Restore** any of them.

Tender Monitor v1.0.0DashboardPortalsTendersArchiveScan HistorySettingsIdle

Archived Tenders (1)

Back to TendersRestore all

All portals▼KeywordTender IDOrganisationLocationAny status▼

Any relevance▼Min valueMax valuePublished fromdd-mm-yyyyto dd-mm-yyyyFilterReset

PORTAL	TENDER	ORGANISATION	PUBLISHED	CLOSING	VALUE	RELEVANCE	STATUS
West Bengal eProcurement	Supply of laboratory equipment 2026_PWD_1038160_1 NIeT-26/RS/26-27/07	PWD Howrah	2026-09-12	2026-09-25	Rs. 2,00,000	LOW 15	existingRestore

Tender Monitor runs entirely on your computer. Next scheduled scan: 2026-09-15T08:00:00+05:30

The Archive page - old tenders, searchable, with Restore.

Updates are never lost: if a tender you archived later changes (a corrigendum or new closing date), the next scan automatically brings it back into the active list so you notice it.

12. Step 10 - Download the Excel report

Click **Download Excel** (on the Dashboard or the Tenders page) to get a full report file named like `Tender_Report_2026-09-14.xlsx` . It contains ready-to-use sheets:

- NEW TENDERS, UPDATED TENDERS, ALL ACTIVE TENDERS
- CLOSING WITHIN 7 DAYS, CLOSING WITHIN 30 DAYS
- DOCUMENT DOWNLOADS, PORTAL STATUS, SCAN SUMMARY, ERRORS

Headers are frozen, filters are on, and links to the tender pages and documents are clickable. Tip: in the NEW TENDERS sheet you can filter the **Published** column to today's date to see only today's fresh tenders.

13. Step 11 - Automatic daily scans

There are two ways to run scans automatically:

a) While the app is open

If a portal's Schedule is **Daily** (or Weekly), the app scans it at the set time as long as the app window is running. The Dashboard shows the **Next Scheduled Scan**.

b) Even when the app is closed (recommended)

Use Windows Task Scheduler so scans run in the background:

1. Double-click **setup_scheduler.bat** in the app folder.
2. Type the time you want (e.g. `07:00`) and press Enter.
3. It creates a daily Windows task named **TenderMonitorDaily** that scans all your portals - the app window does not need to be open.

If Windows asks for administrator permission, right-click **setup_scheduler.bat** and choose *Run as administrator*.

14. Step 12 - Settings (timezone & email)

Open **Settings** from the top menu.

Tender Monitor v1.0.0 Dashboard Portals Tenders Archive Scan History Settings Idle

Settings

General

Timezone (IANA, e.g. Asia/Kolkata)

Asia/Kolkata

Email Notifications (optional)

SMTP Host	SMTP Port
	587
SMTP Username	SMTP Password
From Email	To Email
Use TLS	
☒ Enable STARTTLS	
Enable notifications	Only if new tenders
☐ On	☒ On
Only high relevance	Only errors
☐ On	☐ On
Attach Excel	
☒ On	

Save Settings

Credentials are stored locally in the SQLite database and never written to logs.

Tender Monitor runs entirely on your computer. Next scheduled scan: 2026-09-15T08:00:00+05:30

Settings - timezone and optional email notifications.

- **Timezone** - leave as `Asia/Kolkata` unless you are elsewhere. This controls what "today" means and the times shown.
- **Email notifications (optional)** - if you want a daily summary emailed to you, fill in your email provider's SMTP details, tick **Enable notifications**, and choose when to send (only if new tenders, only high relevance, etc.). Leave blank if you do not want email - everything works without it.

Your settings and passwords are stored only on your computer and are never shown in the logs.

15. Handy tips

Clone a portal

To watch several state portals with the same keywords, set one up, then on the **Portals** page click **Clone**. It copies every setting into a new portal and opens it for editing - just change the **Name** and **URL** and Save.

Choosing good keywords

Keywords decide what counts as relevant. Use the words that appear in tender titles, e.g. for water works: water, pipeline, WTP, STP, JJM, sewerage, water treatment . Add **Negative Keywords** to remove noise, e.g. vehicle, security, canteen .

16. Your everyday routine

1. Open the app (double-click **start.bat**) - or let the daily Windows task scan for you.
2. Go to **Tenders** and click **New today** (optionally set **Relevance = HIGH**).
3. Open any tender to read details and download its documents.
4. Click **Download Excel** to save/share the report.
5. Click **Archive reviewed** to clear what you have handled - tomorrow only new ones appear.

That is the whole daily loop: **New today** → **review** → **Excel** → **Archive reviewed**.

17. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
"Python was not found" during install	Install Python 3.12+ and tick "Add Python to PATH", then run install.bat again.
The browser page shows <code>{"detail": "Not Found"}</code> after an update	The app needs a restart to load changes. Close the black window (or stop.bat) and run start.bat again.
A portal says CAPTCHA REQUIRED / LOGIN REQUIRED	That site is protected and cannot be automated. This is expected for some portals.
A site briefly shows an error or "503"	The website is busy or blocking automated visits. Wait a while and scan again.
"Archive older/reviewed" seems to do nothing	Check the green message it shows - if everything is from today, there may be nothing unchanged to archive yet. Use "Archive all" to clear fully.
Port 8000 already in use	Another copy is running. Close all black windows and start again, or use a different port.
Where are my files?	Inside the app folder: <code>data\downloads</code> (documents), <code>data\reports</code> (Excel), <code>data\logs</code> (logs).

18. Quick reference

File	Use
<code>install.bat</code>	Run once to set everything up.
<code>start.bat</code>	Start the app (opens the Dashboard in your browser).
<code>stop.bat</code>	Stop the app.
<code>run_scan.bat</code>	Run one scan of all portals (used by the daily task).
<code>setup_scheduler.bat</code>	Set up automatic daily scans in Windows.

Address	<code>http://127.0.0.1:8000</code> (your own computer)
Menu	Dashboard · Portals · Tenders · Archive · Scan History · Settings
Daily loop	New today → review → Download Excel → Archive reviewed

Tender Monitor - by Ganguly B (Shavarna) · enlaceet@gmail.com · WhatsApp +91-9073288770
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